

DAN GARRETT

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S UMMARY

A driven and successful information technology manager with an extensive background in system architecture and implementation, ensuring SDLC guideline and global operation compliance with continued support, and documentation requirements are met. Uses excellent communication and interpersonal skills to act as the main point of contact for change management queries and deployment. With a proven track record of extensive and successful leadership experience, utilizes a vast background, knowledge and professional skill set to contribute to significant increases in revenue and business growth.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- ***Platforms:*** Microsoft Azure, Amazon Web Services (AWS), Hyper-V Virtualization, Microsoft Windows Server, Microsoft SQL Server, multi-tiered web application design and deployment, Ubuntu Linux (Debian-based Linux), Amazon Linux (Red Hat-based Linux).
- ***Technologies:*** Cloud technologies, Active Directory / Entra ID, DNS, DHCP, Data Stores, Fibre-attached SAN, iSCSI, BS/DR high-availability failover strategies, PBX, ISDN, TCP/IP, VoIP, Cisco switches and routers, F5 BigIP appliances, Juniper Networks hardware systems, implementation and support of enterprise level data storage with high availability and critical level uptime utilizing clustering, mirroring, and log-shipping solutions. Scripting/Languages: Python, PowerShell, Perl, Batch, VBScript, HTML, TSQL, C/C++.

EXPERIENCE

Microsoft, Redmond, WA

Digital Cloud Solution Architect, Sept 2022 - Feb 2025

- Drove and managed client engagements for repeatable achievement of revenue and consumption targets
- Leveraged best practices to guide customer strategy and future growth for Microsoft services
- Collaborate and orchestrate with other Cloud Solution Architects and MS stakeholders, including FastTrack, Solution Assessments, etc., in developing cloud solutions on Azure
- Designed, implemented, and maintained scalable end-to-end CI/CD pipelines using GitLab CI/CD to automate the build, test, security scanning, and deployment processes for over 50 microservices
- Designed architectural solutions to meet business and IT needs, ensuring technical viability of new projects and successful deployments, while orchestrating key resources and infusing key Infrastructure technologies
- Developed and demonstrated a production-ready CI/CD pipeline using GitLab CI/CD and ArgoCD for a key financial services client, automating their Java Spring Boot application deployment onto AKS (Azure Kubernetes Service) and reducing their release cycle from bi-weekly to daily
- Integrated GitLab CI pipelines with external tools including SonarQube for code quality, JFrog Artifactory for artifact management, and Slack for automated notifications
- Delivered Architectural Design Sessions to build cohesive plans for implementing solutions aligning to customer business goals and technical environments
- Implemented GitOps practices using ArgoCD for automated, synchronized deployments across development, staging, and production Kubernetes clusters, ensuring state always matched the version-controlled manifest
- Cultivated customer affinity with Microsoft programs/solutions that drive impact for the customer
- Conducted analyses into what customers are using versus needs and reviewed results with clients
- Created and open-sourced a Terraform-based reference implementation on Azure featuring a secure, scalable CI/CD architecture built on GitLab CI for integration and ArgoCD for GitOps-based deployment, which was adopted by 5+ enterprise accounts
- Managed and configured ArgoCD Applications and AppProjects to enable self-service deployments for development teams while maintaining security and governance standards
- Represented customers by providing feedback to Microsoft on development needs, blockers, or mitigation strategies
- Conducted hands-on Architectural Design Sessions (ADS) and workshops where I built functional pipeline prototypes with GitLab CI and ArgoCD to prove technical feasibility and accelerate client adoption of DevOps practices
- Drive greater consumption (cloud and support) with customers based on analysis of both usage and needs
- Architected a complete GitOps workflow where GitLab CI/CD pipelines compiled, tested, and built container images, and then updated Kubernetes manifests which were automatically deployed by ArgoCD upon merge to main

- Leverage insights to provide guidance and recommendations to customers in order to drive, retain, and optimize customer consumption
- Apply technical knowledge and customer insights to create a modernization roadmap

IBM, Seattle, WA

Customer Success Manager - Architect, Sept 2021 - May 2022

- Partner with IBM Blue Diamond and Passport Advantage customers to realize the full value of their cloud-based AI software portfolio
- Guide customers through their journey from on-premise to fully cloud driven applications and architecture with IBM cloud software and AI services
- Demonstrate solutions with Proof-of-Concept (PoC) and Minimum Viable Product (MVP) designs driven by customer needs and requirements
- Advise the customer on new and upcoming IBM offerings and services to enable growth and expand AI usage
- Advocate for the customer with engineering and customer support teams

- Guide customers through their software renewal periods

Qumulo, Inc., Seattle, WA

Cloud Solution Architect, Dec 2020 - Aug 2021

- Collaborated with potential customers to understand their needs and provide comprehensive solutions using the company's cloud-based products in Azure and AWS; acted as a pre-sales engineering resource
- Collaborated with existing customers and create solutions using the company's cloud-based products in Azure and AWS; acted as a post-sales engineering resource
- Assisted customers setting up cloud-based environments for use in healthcare, media and entertainment, and on-premise to cloud migrations of critical user data
- Perform functional testing of the company's cloud-based products in sandbox environments to aid engineering in improving the products' performance and stability
- Created custom scripts for the automation of deployment for the company's cloud-based products using Terraform (for AWS and Azure) and CloudFormation (for AWS only)

McGraw Hill, Seattle, WA

Technical Service Delivery Manager, Jun 2018 - Jul 2020

- Acted as main contact point for change management queries and implementation approvals, ensuring that established SDLC guidelines have been followed.
- Answered and acted on global operations queries, resolving or redirecting them to specialized teams as necessary.
- Performed call leader duties for troubleshooting conference calls during major incidents.
- Drove root cause analysis and related problem management for all major incidents.
- Conducted yearly reviews of top-tier critical applications to prepare for and ensure optimum performance and uptime prior to each yearly busy season.
- Assessed, reviewed, and created documentation for all company operational touch points.
- Managed Exigence incident management system.

Amazon Web Services, Seattle, WA

Technical Account Manager, Jun 2016 - Mar 2018

- Serve as principal technical advisor and 'voice of customer' for Enterprise level customers.
- Worked directly with customers to craft and execute strategies to drive customer adoption and use of AWS cloud services.
- Maintained relationship with customer to create positive partner experience and solid feedback channel to understand business and operational needs and technical challenges.
- Drove discussions on operational excellence and security, including educating on global, highly available designs, monitoring, alerting, and risk management.
- Drove discussions regarding new and upcoming technologies, helping them innovate for future and become cloud pioneers in their respective markets.
- Acted on customer's behalf to escalate issues to senior leadership and engineering teams to resolve critical problems and deliver feedback to drive product innovation.
- Provided reports to Executive Leadership as necessary
- Led hands-on assistance preparing for large-scale events and software launches, ensuring proper SDLC guidelines have been followed.

Cloud Support Engineer, Dec 2012 - Mar 2016

- Assisted users with cloud-based services and applications with problem troubleshooting and new user guidance through documentation, known best practices, and personal experience.
- Engineered automated solutions in Python and PowerShell to resolve common customer issues with EC2, EBS, S3, and RDS, with scripts adopted internally by the wider support organization.
- Provided customers with architectural guidance based on best practices of company's cloud-based services in order to bring best value and availability to customer for their needs.
- Developed and maintained IaC scripts using CloudFormation to create standardized, replicable customer environments for troubleshooting and proof-of-concept purposes.
- Supported using and deploying Amazon EC2, EBS, S3, ELB, WorkSpaces, RDS, DynamoDB.
- Acted as an internal SRE for supported services, conducting deep-dive analyses on system failures, contributing to root

cause analysis (RCA) documents, and implementing monitoring checks in CloudWatch to prevent future incidents.

- Developed training materials for new AWS services, and lead classroom trainings for said services to my peers in Support organization.
- Built and documented complex, multi-tier AWS architectures (web app, database, load balancing) to demonstrate best practices for performance, security, and high availability to enterprise customers.
- Trained new cloud support engineers in all AWS services.
- Automated the deployment of standardized training and demo environments for internal teams using CloudFormation, reducing setup time from days to minutes.

- Acted as Subject Matter Expert for Windows-based operating systems and cloud services.
- Collaborated with Windows-based service engineering teams on regular basis, acting as voice of support and of customer for issues and new Microsoft services.
- Collaborated with enterprise-level account managers, bringing technical expertise and guidance to assist with large-scale and high-impact customer issues.
- Created, tracked, and managed customer escalations to cloud service engineering teams.
- Assisted with support department's operational tasks to keep customer appreciation levels high.

Microsoft, Redmond, WA

Senior Operations Engineer, Jun 2008 - Dec 2012

- Implemented mission critical SQL database servers across Microsoft's global network, provisioning regular maintenance and monitoring for highest levels of availability.
- Configured and maintained load-balancing hardware for IIS web servers.
- Managed customer and operations escalations - initiation, troubleshooting, tracking, and completion.
- Deployed application builds and system updates across global infrastructure of IIS and SQL servers for group's application portfolio.
- Wrote technical analysis and layout diagrams of application environment across multiple datacenters dispersed globally.
- Interacted and maintained relationships with development teams, incident management teams, and intra-organization operations teams to achieve common goals.
- Authored departmental knowledge-base and help articles for supported application.
- Designed and implemented automated server deployment of application updates across globally diverse infrastructure.
- Provided extended- and after-hours operational support as necessary.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

ATOS, Redmond, WA, Support Analyst 3, 2007-2008. Engaged in Level 3 Incident Management for Microsoft's Online Service Management (OSM) organization supporting Microsoft Partner Portal and its associated Content Management System in production and pre-production environments. Managed and maintained global production environment to achieve peak levels of performance and availability for customers worldwide. Interacted and maintained relationships with development teams, incident management teams, and operations teams to achieve common goals.

Orrtax Software Solutions, Bellevue, WA, Systems Engineer, 2005-2007. Provided leadership and assistance in network systems administration, telecom operations, and support service for company's mission critical, zero-downtime operations center. Provided hardware acquisition, configuration, maintenance, repair, training, and troubleshooting support for internal staff. Installed, maintained and managed new and existing IIS and SQL datacenter servers.

ATOS, Issaquah, WA, Support Analyst 3, 2004-2005. Worked exclusively with product development staff to set up and maintain test environment for fledgling product in test lab on Microsoft campus utilizing Microsoft Windows Server systems. Procured, installed, and managed all hardware and software in test lab to mimic data center installation to meet project development requirements

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified Azure Solutions Architect Expert

Amazon Web Services, Solutions Architect Associate, SysOps Associate

Microsoft Certified IT Professional (MCITP), Database Administrator

Microsoft Certified Professional, Microsoft Windows NT 4.0 Server, Server 2000, Server 2003

ITIL v3 Foundation Certified

EDUCATION

Highline College, Des Moines, WA

September 1994 - December 1997

Computer Science

Western Washington University, Bellingham, WA
September 1993 - June 1994
Computer Science